END-OF-YEAR TEST● ANSWER KEY

Writing

Sample answers

Option A

Can write about everyday things (e.g. people, places, job, study) in linked sentences.

Can write short, simple notes, emails and postings to friends.

Can use appropriate openings and endings in simple informal emails.

Hi Laura

How are you? How is your family?

I am on holiday with my family. We are in Italy, near a big city called Florence. It's a lovely place because the countryside around Florence is very beautiful and the city is interesting.

We came here by plane. The flight took two hours and it was good – I like flying! We have rented a house for two weeks.

The weather has been fantastic. It has been sunny and warm every day. It has been hot but not too hot to walk around the city.

In the next few days, we are going to visit a big church in the city and go to some villages. You can buy great local food in the restaurants.

Anyway, see you soon.

Love,

XYZ

Option B

Can write very short basic descriptions of events, past activities and personal experiences.

Can express a simple opinion or argument in a short text.

This entry is about our school trip to the Natural History Museum. We went there because we are doing a project on oceans and there was a big exhibition about seas and oceans.

We travelled there by bus and first looked at all the things about the sea. Then we watched a film about the problems with the environment and how the oceans are in trouble. I did these things with the whole of my class. I really enjoyed the film. Then I went to the museum shop with my best friend, Jaime. I bought some pencils. He got a DVD.

On our next trip I would like to go to a big city to see the sights. There are lots of interesting things to do there.

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Mark scheme

The task is worth 20 marks. Award up to 4 marks for each section of the mark scheme, according to the descriptions below. The same mark scheme can be used for both tasks.

Marks	Content	Task achievement	Organisation and structure	Range	Accuracy
0–1	May not cover all the content points, or in insufficient depth and/or scope. Content would have a negative effect on the intended reader due to lexical and/or grammatical inaccuracies and/or poor control of register.	Lexical and grammatical inaccuracies impede task achievement. Control may be sufficient for very simple tasks but not more complex ones.	Little or no text organisation according to genre. Text organised at phrase or sentence level. Little or no linking between sentences.	Uses only very basic vocabulary and grammar structures, perhaps with a lot of errors. No complex or compound sentences.	Many lexical and grammatical errors, even in basic language, which impede communication of ideas.
2–3	All points may have been covered, but some in insufficient depth. Sections of the content would probably have a positive effect on the intended reader.	Control is sufficient to respond to all simple tasks and to complete some more complex ones. The majority of the response would achieve is intended purpose.	Text organised largely at sentence level. Some simple and logically-sequenced sections with linking between sentences. There may be evidence of paragraphing, but this may be inappropriate.	Uses basic vocabulary, but largely used accurately. Uses basic grammar structures, perhaps with a few errors. Probably no complex, but possibly some compound, sentences.	A number of lexical and grammatical errors probably evident but not in sufficient quantity to greatly impede communication of ideas.
4	All content points covered with sufficient depth and scope. The text would have a positive effect on the intended reader due to good lexical and/or grammatical accuracy and/or sufficient control of register.	Control of language is clearly sufficient to respond to simple and more complex tasks. There is demonstrable achievement of all parts of the task.	Text organised and sequenced simply but logically throughout. Linking between sentences throughout. Paragraphs used appropriately for the purpose and genre of the writing.	Uses a good range of level-appropriate vocabulary and grammar structures. Largely used accurately. Possibly some complex and/or compound sentences.	Occasional lexical and grammatical errors probably evident but not in sufficient quantity or severity to impede the communication of ideas.

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